METRIC

A-A-20291
January 8, 1999

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CAULIFLOWER FLORETS, FRESH CUT

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers fresh cut cauliflower florets, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Raw ingredients: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be prepared from U.S. Commercial Grade or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Cauliflower.

2.2 Preparation: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be clean and wholesome. The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be prepared by washing with potable water, sorting, trimming, and cutting in accordance with good commercial practice.

2.3 Finished product:

2.3.1 Appearance: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall have a diameter of 2.54 to 6.35 cm (1 to 2-½ inches) at the widest part of the floret crown with less than 5 percent of the floret crowns being over 6.35 cm (2-½ inches). The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall have a length of 2.54 to 3.81 cm (1 to 1-½ inches) with less than 10 percent of the florets having a length over 3.81 cm (1-½ inches).

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3.2 Flavor and odor: Fresh cut cauliflower florets shall possess good normal characteristic flavor and odor. The finished cauliflower shall be free from objectionable flavors and odors of any kind.

2.3.3 Color: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall possess white, creamy white, or cream characteristic color. The cauliflower florets shall be free from discoloration (such as, but not limited to; yellow or other abnormal color that materially detracts from the appearance, or the edible or marketing quality of the florets).

2.3.4 Texture: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be compact, fresh, and firm. Prepared fresh cut cauliflower florets shall not be tough, fiberous, or mushy. Fresh cut cauliflower florets shall not be slimy, and shall not be materially affected by riciness or fuzziness.

2.3.5 Grit and silt: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be practically free from grit and silt.

2.3.6 Defects: The prepared fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be free from defects such as, but not limited to; bruising, cuts, discoloration, fuzziness, insects, riciness, mold, and wilting which detract from the appearance, or the edible or marketing quality of the finished product. In order to allow for variations incident to proper defect scoring and handling, the following tolerances are provided as specified: 20 percent for defects, including not more than one percent for finished product affected by decay. Percentages shall be determined on the basis of count.

2.3.7 Sulfites: The fresh cut cauliflower florets may be treated with antioxidants which are listed on the Food and Drug Administration's Substances Generally Recognized As Safe (21 CFR Part 184). However, the prepared fresh cut cauliflower florets shall not be treated with sulfur dioxide or other sulfiting agents as prohibited under provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

2.4 Temperature: The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be kept under refrigeration. Unless otherwise recommended, preparation, storage, and delivery temperatures greater than 0°C (32°F) but not more than 3.3°C (38°F) are recommended.

2.5 Age requirement: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be not be prepared more than 24 hours prior to the required loading time for delivery. Recommended shelf life from time of processing shall not exceed 14 days.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 The delivered fresh cut cauliflower florets shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the fresh cut cauliflower florets within the commercial marketplace. Delivered fresh cut cauliflower florets shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser shall specify 4.1 or 4.2.*

4.1 Product conformance. The fresh cut cauliflower florets provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same fresh cut cauliflower florets offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 USDA certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Fresh Products Branch (FPB), Fruit and Vegetable Programs, USDA, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable FPB procedures. The fresh cut cauliflower florets shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Purchaser shall specify:

- Product conformance (5.1) or USDA certification (5.2) for fresh cut cauliflower.

6.2 USDA certification contact.

For USDA certification, contact the Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 Sources of documents.

6.3.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P. O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit Card (MasterCard or VISA) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1803 **or on the Internet at: http:// www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) prohibits discrimination in all its programs and activities on the basis of race, color, national origin, gender, religion, age, disability, political beliefs, sexual orientation, and marital or familial status. (Not all prohibited bases apply to all programs.) Persons with disabilities who require alternative means for communication of program information (Braille, large print, audiotape, etc.) should contact USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TDD).

To file a complaint of discrimination, write USDA, Director, Office of Civil Rights, Room 326-W, Whitten Building, 14th and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-9410 or call (202) 720-5964 (voice or TDD). USDA is an equal opportunity provider and employer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.